



## Volendam — 2028 Grand World Voyage

129 days · round-trip Fort Lauderdale · departs January 4, 2028

**Ship:** ms Volendam (Holland America Line) · **From/to:** Port Everglades, Fort Lauderdale · **Cabin:** \_\_\_\_\_

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in four pages. The full pack covers the ship, all eight legs and 45 ports, the pre-cruise year, four-season packing, the whole budget, and the emergency framework in depth.

### The voyage, leg by leg

Port order follows Holland America's published route map; **every date below is approximate until your cruise documents finalize it** — and world-cruise itineraries change en route. That's part of the deal.

| Leg | ~When   | Route                                                                                                                                                                                                             | The one thing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | Jan     | <b>Caribbean &amp; Brazil</b> — San Juan · Barbados · Devil's Island · Belém · Recife · Rio (extended) · Montevideo · Buenos Aires (extended)                                                                     | Settle in, don't sprint. First equator crossing. Fix any cold-kit gaps in Buenos Aires — it's the last big store before the ice.                                                                                                                    |
| 2   | Feb     | <b>Patagonia &amp; Antarctica</b> — Port Stanley · Ushuaia · 4-day Antarctic Experience (scenic, no landings) · Cape Horn · Punta Arenas · Glacier Alley & Chilean fjords · Puerto Montt · San Antonio (Santiago) | The summit of the trip. Full cold kit + hand warmers on deck; the Crow's Nest is the warm seat. Falklands penguin trips book out — decide early.                                                                                                    |
| 3   | Feb–Mar | <b>The long Pacific</b> — Easter Island (tender, swell-dependent) · Pitcairn · Papeete (evening) · Moorea · Bora Bora                                                                                             | Hold Easter Island loosely — ships miss it some years; the moai are worth the gamble. The whole Pacific run stays south of the equator. Sun protection becomes a medical topic.                                                                     |
| 4   | Mar     | <b>New Zealand</b> — 8 days, 6 ports: Auckland (overnight) · Tauranga · New Plymouth · Wellington · Picton · Lyttelton                                                                                            | Densest port stretch of the voyage. One thing per port, not three. Biosecurity is serious: declare food, clean shoes.                                                                                                                               |
| 5   | Mar     | <b>Australia &amp; Indonesia</b> — Sydney (overnight) · Brisbane · Townsville · Cairns · Torres Strait · Darwin · Komodo · Bali                                                                                   | The Sydney sail-in is the canonical arrival. Reef operators in Cairns book early. Komodo is ranger-escorted only.                                                                                                                                   |
| 6   | Apr     | <b>SE Asia &amp; Indian Ocean</b> — Singapore (overnight) · Phuket · Colombo (evening) · Malé · Port Louis · Réunion                                                                                              | The second equator crossing comes on the run up to Singapore, the third southbound to Mauritius. Hawker centers over hotel restaurants in Singapore; hottest sustained stretch of the voyage. Réunion's cirque viewpoints are the taxi-day to take. |
| 7   | Apr     | <b>Africa</b> — Durban · <b>Cape Town (65 hours)</b> · Lüderitz · Walvis Bay · Null Island sail-past · Takoradi · Abidjan                                                                                         | Table Mountain on the first clear morning, not the "scheduled" one. Robben Island books weeks ahead. Null Island is the fourth and final equator crossing, exactly at 0°, 0°. Cape Coast Castle deserves its gravity.                               |
| 8   | Apr–May | <b>Atlantic home</b> — Praia · Mindelo · crossing · San Juan · Fort Lauderdale                                                                                                                                    | The crossing is the decompression chamber. The journal you kept is about to be priceless.                                                                                                                                                           |

**The world-cruise packing rule:** you're outfitting a small life, not packing a trip. ~10–12 days of clothes + the ship's laundry, one full Antarctic layering kit (thermal base, fleece mid, windproof waterproof shell, hand warmers), twice the sun protection you think, and two dressy outfits re-worn without apology.

**Currency aboard:** USD. **Crew Appreciation:** \$18/day per person (standard) / \$20 (suites) — \$2,322 / \$2,580 across 129 days; rates as of mid-2026, reconfirm at booking.

## The pre-cruise year — compressed

### 12+ months out (the can't-rush items):

- **Passport valid into 2029** with plentiful blank pages. Renew now if in doubt — every visa keys off it.
- **Travel-medicine clinic, itinerary in hand** — yellow fever (with certificate) and malaria decisions for West Africa are clinical calls needing lead time.
- **Insurance with medical-evacuation cover** — and check the per-trip duration cap; many policies stop at 90 days, which quietly disqualifies them for a 129-day voyage.
- **Book the cabin you can live in.** Ocean View over Interior matters more on 129 days than on any week-long cruise.

**9 months out:** bills on autopay · mail forwarded · **prescription vacation-override** started with your insurer (130+ days of meds, original bottles, carry-on) · house watched weekly (check your homeowner policy's vacancy clause).

**6 months out:** final payment (Grand Voyage schedule differs — calendar it at booking) · life-list excursions that sell out (South Africa safari add-on, Robben Island, Cairns reef, Falklands penguins) · flights to Fort Lauderdale **arriving Jan 3 at the latest.**

**Final month:** pack early enough to discover what you don't own · do the handoff card with your at-home contact out loud · say goodbyes with slack — four months is long enough for life at home to move.

## Budget snapshot (per person, double occupancy — mid-2026 figures, all approximate)

| Line                             | Range                                                       |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fare at booking opening          | Interior ~\$29,999 · Ocean View ~\$34,499 · Suite ~\$57,599 |
| Crew Appreciation (129 days)     | \$2,322 standard · \$2,580 suite                            |
| Shore excursions                 | \$2,000–6,000+ (the widest-variance line)                   |
| Bar / specialty / spa            | \$1,000–4,000                                               |
| Internet (voyage-length package) | \$500–1,500                                                 |
| Visas, vaccines, insurance       | \$1,500–4,000+                                              |
| Port cash & misc                 | \$1,500–3,000                                               |

All-in for two in an Ocean View: plan around **\$85,000–100,000 per couple** — roughly \$330–390 per person per day for housing, food, transport, and six continents. Ship excursions at the remote tender ports (where ship-waits-for-you is worth real money); independent in the easy card cities (NZ, Australia, Singapore, Cape Town).

---

## The short list that matters

### Two numbers, memorized by your at-home contact:

- **Holland America emergency lines:** +1 (800) 426-0327 (Pacific business hours) / +1 (800) 628-4771 (after hours & holidays; critical emergencies only: +1 (206) 626-7382) — they confirm you boarded and relay messages to the ship anywhere on earth.
- **U.S. State Department 24/7:** +1 (888) 407-4747 (from abroad: +1 (202) 501-4444) — routes to the right embassy for whichever of the 26 countries the ship is in. Enroll in **STEP** (step.state.gov) before sailing.

**Silence math for a world cruise:** the Antarctic days, the Pacific, and the Indian Ocean make **multi-day quiet completely normal**. Agree on the rhythm before sailing (“a message every port day; don’t worry between them”) and write it on the handoff card.

**Tender ports (conditions decide):** Devil’s Island · Port Stanley · Easter Island · Moorea · Bora Bora · Komodo · Malé. Plan them as “if the sea allows” days; the docked cities carry the schedule.

**On the ship:** the Crow’s Nest (forward observation lounge) is the scenic-day seat · the wrap-around promenade mile is the voyage’s best free amenity · Pinnacle Grill and Canaletto are the specialty venues · the Lido Pool’s sliding roof covers every climate you’ll cross · dial 90 from any ship phone for Guest Services, 24/7.

**Sea-day survival:** the week-six wall is real and it passes · budget energy like money · **journal ten minutes a night from Day 1** — by Cape Town you will not remember Recife without it.

**Fill in when documents arrive:** cabin \_\_\_\_\_ · muster station \_\_\_\_\_ · dining time \_\_\_\_\_ · Wi-Fi package \_\_\_\_\_ · onboard account card \_\_\_\_\_

---

*Need the at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc ships with this pack. The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion; the PWA companion app (volendam-world-2028) carries the live route, weather, and this card offline. Soli Deo Gloria.*